

Algorithms

Lecture #44

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Reductions

Reductions

Reductions

Consider the question:

- Suppose there are two problems, A and B.
- You know (or you strongly believe at least) that it is impossible to solve problem A in polynomial time.
- You want to prove that B cannot be solved in polynomial time.

Reductions

Reductions

- How would you do this?
- We want to show that

$$(A \notin P) \Rightarrow (B \notin P)$$

Reductions

Reductions

Consider an example to illustrate reduction:

The following problem is well-known to be NPC:

3-color: Given a graph G , can each of its vertices can be labelled with one of 3 different colors such that two adjacent vertices have the same label (color).

Reductions

Reductions

- Coloring arises in various partitioning problems where there is a constraint that two objects cannot be assigned to the same set of partitions.
- The term “coloring” comes from the original application which was in map drawing.
- Two countries that share a common border should be colored with different colors.

Reductions

Reductions

- It is well known that planar graphs can be colored (maps) with **four colors**.
- There exists a polynomial time algorithm for this.
- But determining whether this can be done with 3 colors is hard and there is no polynomial time algorithm for it.

Reductions

Reductions



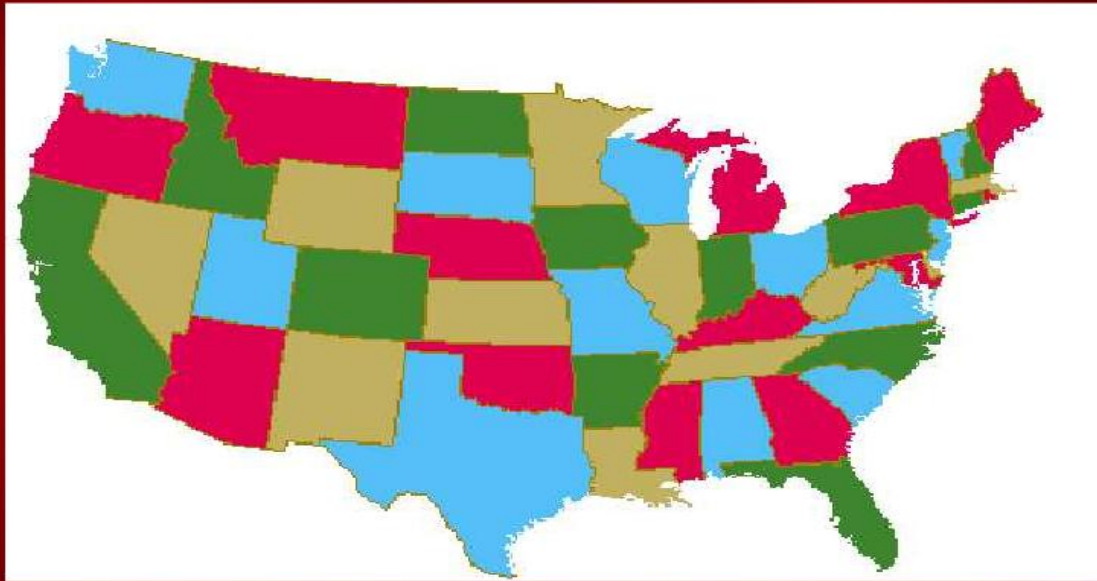
South America Neighbors

South America Neighbors



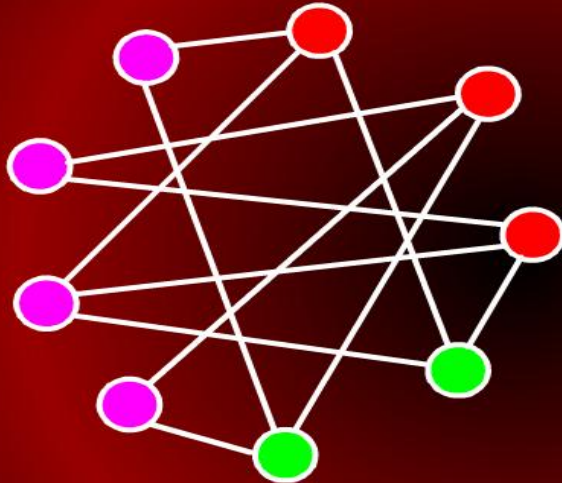
USA Map

USA Map

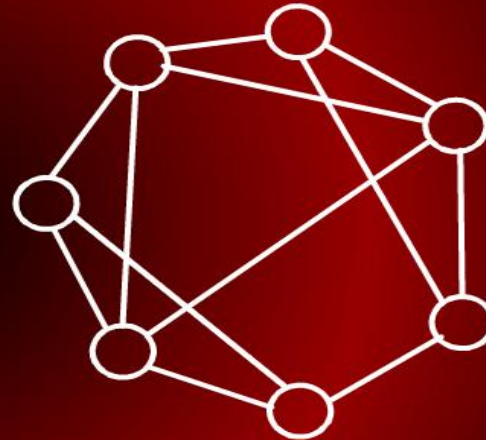


3-Colorable

3-Colorable



3-Colorable



Not 3-colorable

Graph Coloring: Fish Tank

Graph Coloring: Fish Tank

- A tropical fish hobbyist had six different types of fish designated by A, B, C, D, E, and F, respectively.
- Because of predator-prey relationships, water conditions and size, some fish can be kept in the same tank.

Graph Coloring: Fish Tank

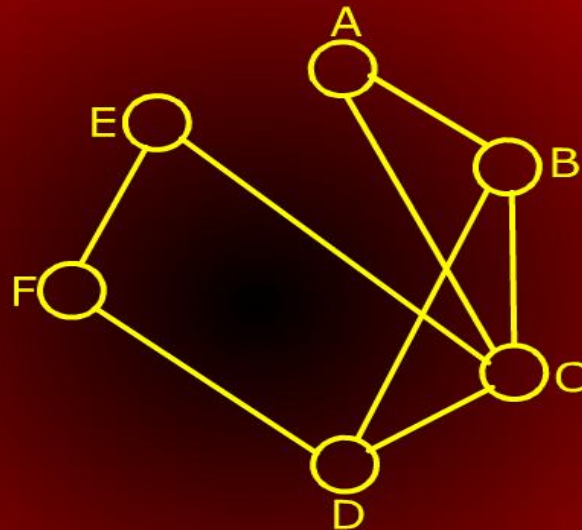
Graph Coloring: Fish Tank

- The following table shows which fish cannot be together:

Type	Cannot be with
A	B, C
B	A, C, E
C	A, B, D, E
D	C, F
E	B, C, F
F	D, E

Graph Coloring: Fish Tank

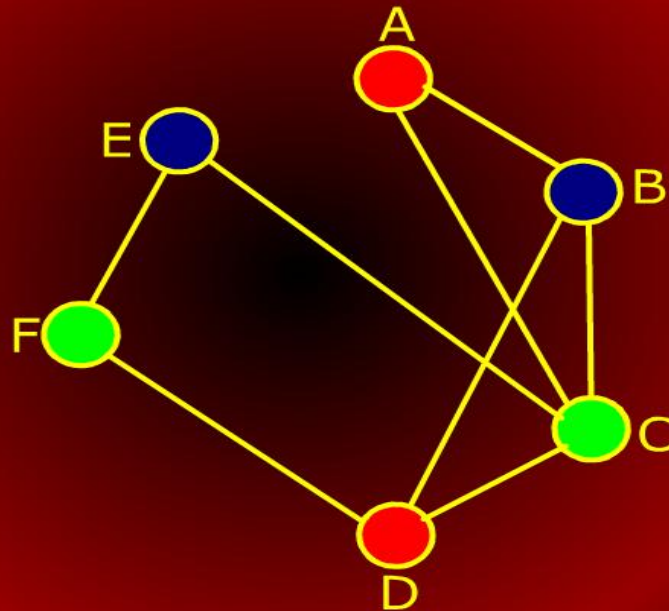
Graph Coloring: Fish Tank



What is the smallest number of tanks needed to keep all the fish?

Graph Coloring: Fish Tank

Graph Coloring: Fish Tank



Graph Coloring: Fish Tank

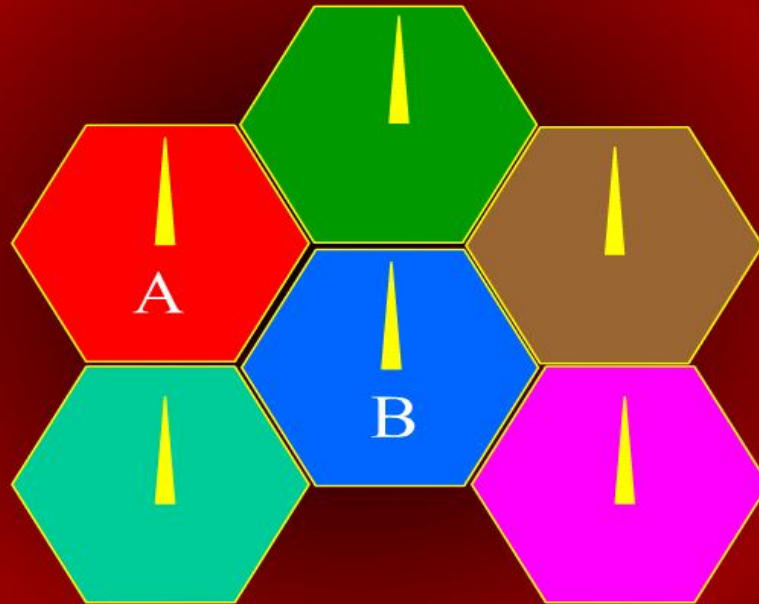
Graph Coloring: Fish Tank

The fewest number of tanks the tropical fish owner will need is three.

Tank 1	Tank 2	Tank 3
A, D	F, C	B, E

Cellular Communication

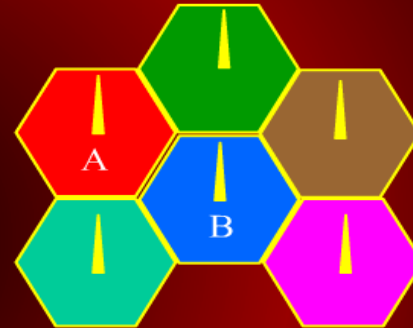
Cellular Communication



Cellular Communication

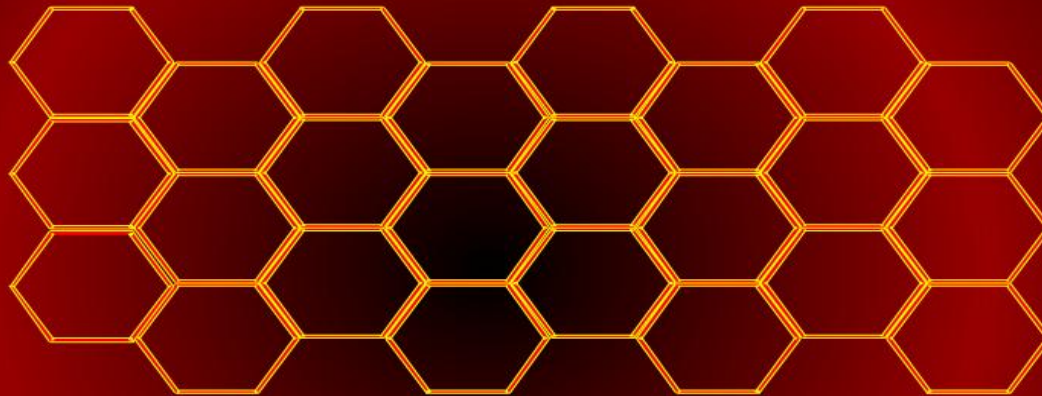
Cellular Communication

- One low power transmitter per cell
- Frequency reuse: limited spectrum
- Handoff: moving to other cells
- Co-channel interference: transmission on same frequency



Cellular Communication

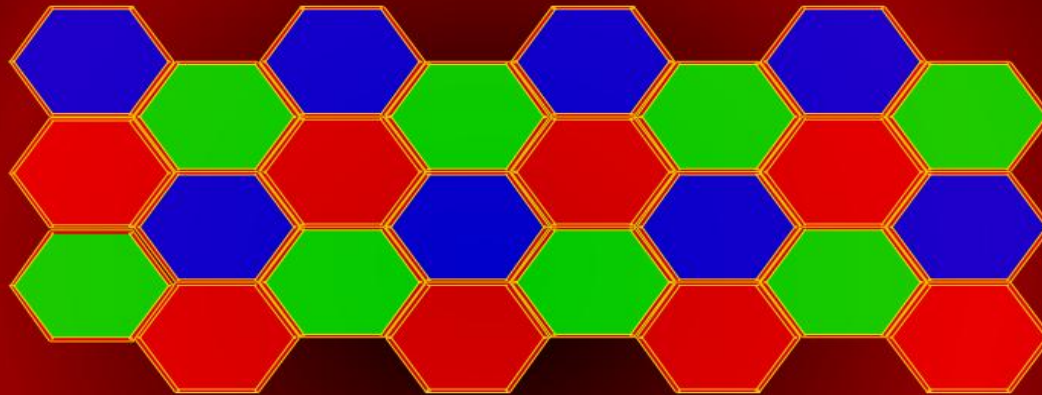
Cellular Communication



Reuse distance: minimum distance between two cells using same channel for satisfactory signal to noise ratio.

Cellular Communication

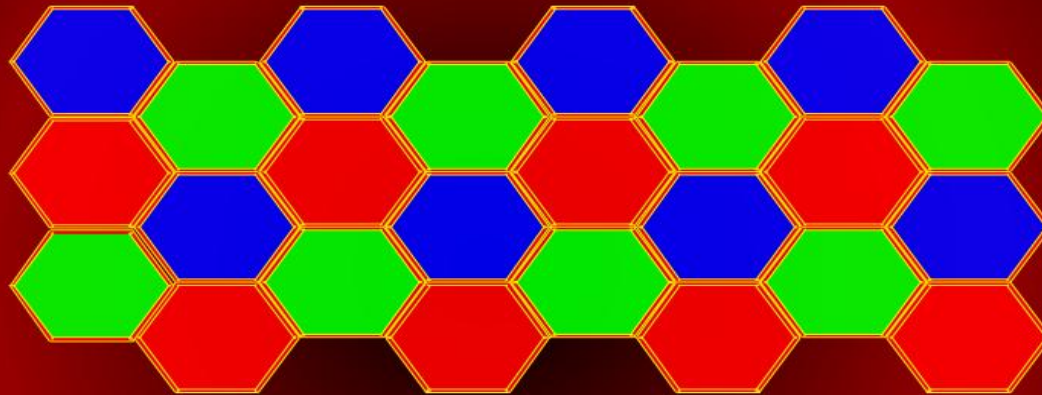
Cellular Communication



One frequency can be (re)used in all cells of the same color.

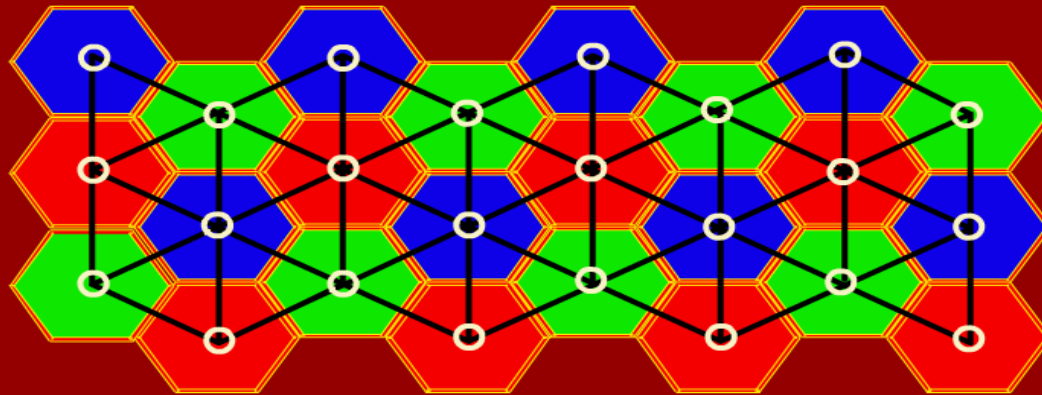
Cellular Communication

Cellular Communication



Minimize number of frequencies=colors

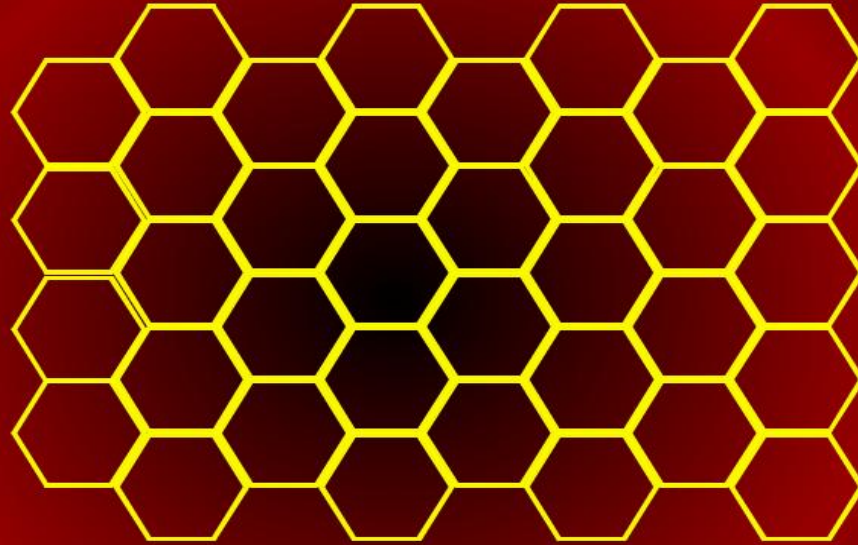
Cellular Communication



What is the graph for reuse distance 2?

Cellular Communication

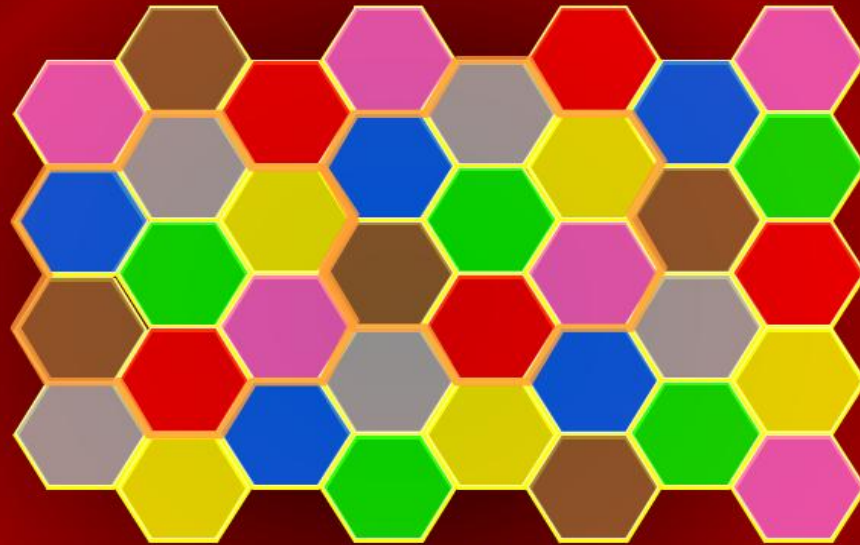
Cellular Communication



Reuse pattern for distance 3?

Cellular Communication

Cellular Communication



What is the graph for reuse distance 3?

Reductions

Reductions

- The 3-color (3Col) problem will play the role of A, which we strongly suspect to not be solvable in polynomial time.
- For our problem B, consider the following problem: